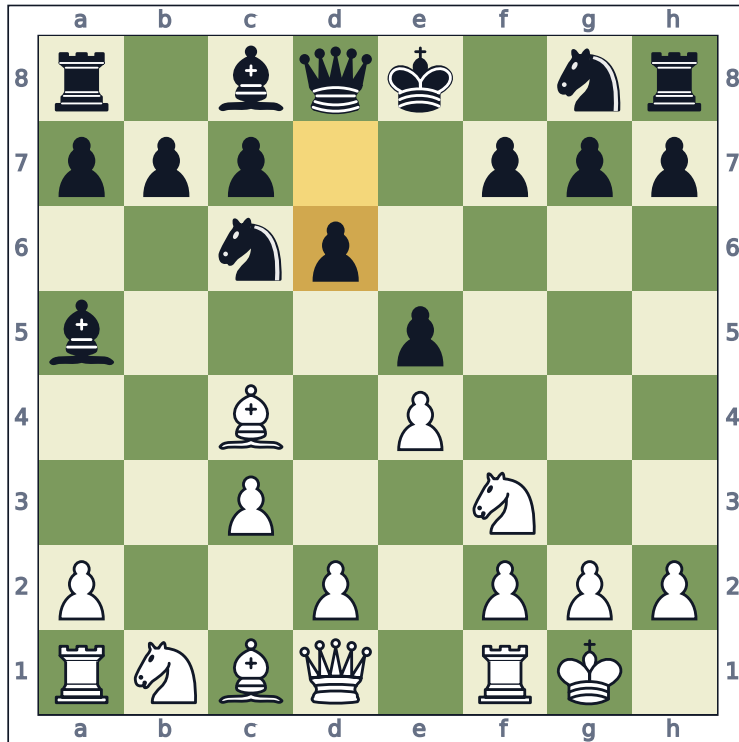


ITALIAN GAME, RUY LOPEZ, AND RELATED OPEN GAMES

Italian Game

ECO C52 | 22 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Playable, but White has already conceded the easier game and must know the compensation or plan.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

-0.68 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Sharp and concrete: initiative, development, and king safety outweigh routine positional rules.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C52 covers Italian Game. White develops with pressure on e5 while Black builds a secure center and seeks the freeing ...d5 break. The diagram uses the featured line Italian Game: Evans Gambit.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. O-O d6

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Castle, prepare d4, improve the least active piece, and preserve pressure rather than forcing tactics that are not ready.

BLACK'S GOALS

Defend e5 efficiently, challenge the center with ...d5, and use queenside or kingside activity according to White's structure.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

d4 and ...d5 define most transformations. c3 often supports d4; ...c5 may challenge a closed center.

PIECE MAP

The bishops on c4/b5 and c5/b4 shape development. Rooks become active on e- and d-files after central exchanges. The material imbalance means development and compensation must be calculated, not assumed.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

The position can look quiet while tactical pressure accumulates on e5, f7, and along central files. Do not judge the gambit only by the pawn count; compare king safety, tempi, and open lines. a gambit is a tactical contract: the sacrificed material must buy concrete time, lines, or targets.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Black is ahead by about 1 pawn unit. Central markers: White pawn on c3, Black pawn on d6, White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e5.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Elite, fully sound opening territory. It rewards patient improvement as much as concrete calculation.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C52 line

This section preserves all 22 names and defining routes assigned to C52 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Italian Game: Evans Gambit
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. O-O d6

002 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Alapin-Steinitz Variation
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. O-O d6 7. d4 Bg4

003 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Anderssen Defense
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. O-O Nf6 7. d4 exd4

004 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Bronstein Defense
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. d4 d6

005 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Compromised Defense
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. d4 exd4 7. O-O dxc3

006 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Compromised Defense, Main Line
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. d4 exd4 7. O-O dxc3 8. Qb3 Qf6 9. e5 Qg6 10. Nxc3 Nge7 11. Ba3

007 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Compromised Defense, Potter Variation
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. d4 exd4 7. O-O dxc3 8. Qb3 Qf6 9. e5 Qg6 10. Nxc3 Nge7 11. Rd1

008 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Dufresne Defense
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. d4 exd4 7. O-O d3

009 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Johner Defense
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. d4 exd4 7. O-O b5

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010 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Laroche Variation
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. d4 Nf6

011 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Lasker Defense
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. O-O d6 7. d4 Bb6

012 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Leonhardt Countergambit
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. d4 b5

013 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Levenfish Variation
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. d4 d6 7. Qb3 Qd7 8. dxe5 dxe5 9. O-O Bb6 10. Ba3 Na5 11. Nxe5

014 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Main Line
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5

015 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Mieses Defense
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. d4 exd4 7. O-O Nge7

016 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Pierce Defense
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. d4 exd4

017 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Richardson Attack
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. O-O Nf6 7. d4 O-O 8. Nxe5

018 Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Sanders-Alapin Variation
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. O-O d6 7. d4 Bd7

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019 **Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Slow Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. O-O

020 **Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Sokolsky Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. d4 d6 7. Bg5

021 **Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Tartakower Attack**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. d4 d6 7. Qb3

022 **Italian Game: Evans Gambit, Waller Attack**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. b4 Bxb4 5. c3 Ba5 6. d4 exd4 7. O-O d6 8. Qb3